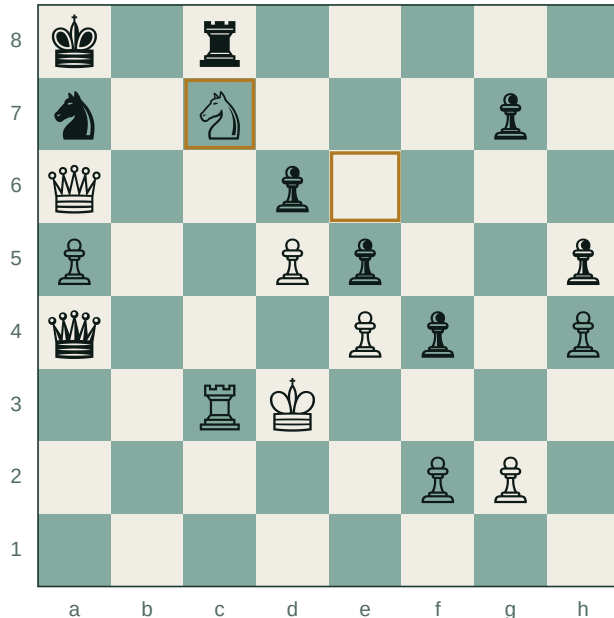


Skewers: Black, move 36

Skewers

Black to move



Previous move: 36.Nxc7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

36...Rxc7 37. Rxc7 Qd1+ 38. Kc3 Qc1+ 39. Kb3 Qxc7

36...Rxc7 The rook captures the knight on c7. Recorded reply: **37.Rxc7**.

37...Qd1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **38.Kc3**.

38...Qc1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **39.Kb3**.

39...Qxc7 The queen captures the rook on c7.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A skewer puts the more important target in front. When that target moves, a piece behind it may be lost. Checks make the geometry especially forcing.

HOW TO LOOK

Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on d3. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.